

Crisis Management

Chapter -1: Crisis, Emergency & Business Continuity Management

1. **Emergency management/response** is the planning and activity associated with detecting, containing, and dealing with the immediate impact of an event.
2. **Crisis management** is strategic and refers to the process of supporting emergency management/response and business continuity operations while dealing strategically with the numerous issues that could impact the long-term viability of the organization.
3. **Business Continuity** refers to the processes and procedures put in place to move from functioning during **crisis to normal operations**.

Emergency Management and Response

4. The four elements of emergency management are mitigation, preparedness, response, and recovery.
 - 4.1. **Mitigation** - activities to reduce the loss of life and property from natural and/or manmade disasters by avoiding or reducing the impact of a disaster.
 - 4.2. **Preparedness** – actions taken before an event to plan, organize, equip, train, and exercise to deal with emergencies that cannot be avoided or entirely mitigated.
 - 4.3. **Response** - activities that address the short-term, direct effects of an incident.
 - 4.4. **Recovery** - involves near-term and long-term actions taken to return the organization to a pre-emergency level of operation.
 - 4.5. **Objectives of Emergency Management**
 - **Minimize** the probability of a threat or emergency.
 - **Mitigate** the impact if the event occurs.
 - **Recover** from the emergency and resume normal operations.

Crisis Management

5. **Definition.** Crisis management is a process that identifies potential impacts that threaten an organization and provides a framework for building resilience.
 - 5.1. Crisis management is holistic and ensures that all functions within the organization are participants in the crisis response.
 - 5.2. The **ultimate goal** of crisis management is to **protect core assets of the organization** (e.g., reputation, brand, financial wellbeing, trust, physical and intellectual property, and key relationships).
 - 5.3. A healthy crisis management program ensures that the program is not dominated by one functional area.
 - 5.4. Crisis Management principles – **Communication, Evaluation, Response.**

Chapter – 2

1. Emergency and Response Teams.

- 1.1. Emergency response personnel should be prepared to function in all types of emergencies even those not anticipated at the time of plan development.
- 1.2. Emergency response requires organization and structure.
- 1.3. **Structure**
 - One operating official should be designated as the organization's emergency coordinator to assume responsibility for the plan.

- The coordinator should be someone regularly responsible for handling emergencies, such as the **head of security or engineering**.
 - To be most effective, this appointment should be documented.
 - **A totally new organization should not be developed to handle emergencies.**
 - Designate alternates for the primary decision maker and for anyone else who is charged, by name or position, with a particular responsibility under the plan.
- 1.4. The emergencies or contingencies for which plans may be developed can be grouped into three major categories: **natural, human and accidental**.

2. Incident Command

2.1. The Incident Command System (ICS) is a command and control mechanism used by many public safety agencies across the globe.

3. Crisis Management Teams (CMT)

- 3.1. The CMT is perhaps the most critical piece of crisis management.
- 3.2. The crisis team should have members from: Human resources, Public affairs, Legal Safety/security, Finance or other shared service, IT, Critical operational departments.
- 3.3. CMT Members should be identified by positions (primary & alternate).
- 3.4. The crisis team must be named in the crisis plan. The crisis team members must be familiar with the plan and should be part of any plan exercises that are conducted.
- 3.5. **Types of Crisis Team**

- **Operational** teams may be responsible for only a segment of the functional operation.
- **Tactical** crisis teams would function closer to the level of the crisis-at the geographic location where the crisis occurred.
- **Strategic** crisis teams exist at the management or executive level of a firm.

Chapter – 3

1. The goal of continuity planning should be:
- Save lives and reduce chances of further injuries or deaths
 - Protect assets
 - Restore critical business processes and systems
 - Reduce the length of the interruption of business
 - Protect reputation damage
 - Control media coverage (eg. local, regional, national, or global)

2. Business Continuity Teams

- 2.1. Business Continuity Teams critical part of the Business continuity process.
- 2.2. Business Continuity Team is treated separately from Crisis Management Team.
- 2.3. These teams are tasked with many aspects of restoration, and participants must be named to the team.

3. Business Continuity Plan

- 3.1. The process of developing a plan is part of the larger risk management process.
- 3.2. The organization should establish, implement, and maintain business continuity plans and procedures to manage a disruptive event and continue its activities based on recovery objectives identified in the business impact analysis.
- 3.3. The plans and procedures should:
- Establish the appropriate internal and external notification and communications protocol.
 - Be specific regarding the immediate steps that should be taken during a disruption.
 - Be flexible to respond to unanticipated threat scenarios.

- Focus on the impact of events that could potentially disrupt operations.
 - Be developed based on stated assumptions and an analysis of interdependencies.
- 3.4. Business continuity response should **support the organization's mission**.
- 3.5. Organizations should conduct a **risk assessment** in order to **identify, evaluate, and prioritize threats and vulnerabilities** to business and how they might impact the organization.
- 3.6. The enterprise cannot be protected if there is no understanding of what needs to be protected.
- 3.7. To determine which prevention and response measures are appropriate, it is necessary to identify the likelihood of crisis incidents and the potential consequences should an incident occur.

4. **Business Continuity Objectives**

- 4.1. Establishing and maintaining documented business continuity objectives consistent with the expectations for organizational activities, relationships outside the organization, and stakeholder requirements is essential.
- 4.2. Business continuity objectives and targets should be measurable qualitatively and/or quantitatively and consistent with the BC policy.
- 4.3. Objectives and targets should be appropriate for the organization, based on the risk assessment and BIA.
- 4.4. Once business continuity objectives and targets are set, the organization should consider establishing key performance indicators (KPI) that align with them.

5. **Identifying and Prioritizing Risks**

- 5.1 The step of identifying and prioritizing enterprise risks to critical assets is typically referred to as **Risk Assessment**.
- 5.2. **Risk identification**. Risk identification ascertains the sources and nature of risk and the effect of uncertainty on achieving the organization's objectives. It can be conducted using qualitative or quantitative analyses.
- 5.3. **Risk Analysis**. Risk analysis is a process to understand the nature and level of risk to determine its significance. The risk analysis process assesses the likelihood and consequence to determine the level of risk and prioritize risk treatments.
- 5.4. **Risk Evaluation**. Risk evaluation uses the risk criteria and outputs from the risk identification and risk analysis steps to determine what risks are acceptable with existing risk treatments and which require additional risk treatment.
- 5.5. **Risk Tolerance**. The amount of uncertainty an organisation is prepared to accept.
- 5.6 **Risk Mitigation Strategies**. Accept, Avoid, Transfer, Reduce.

6. **Business Impact Analysis (BIA)**

- 6.1. BIA is an important part of the BCM planning process that helps an organization identify and evaluate the potential impact of a disruptive event to its operations.
- 6.2 The BIA should address:
- Identifying the potential impact eg. Financial, legal, reputational.
 - Identifying legal, regulatory, and contractual requirements.
 - Estimating the **Maximum Tolerable Downtime** (MTD).
 - Evaluating resource requirements, activity, and external interdependencies to resume operations within the recovery timescales identified.

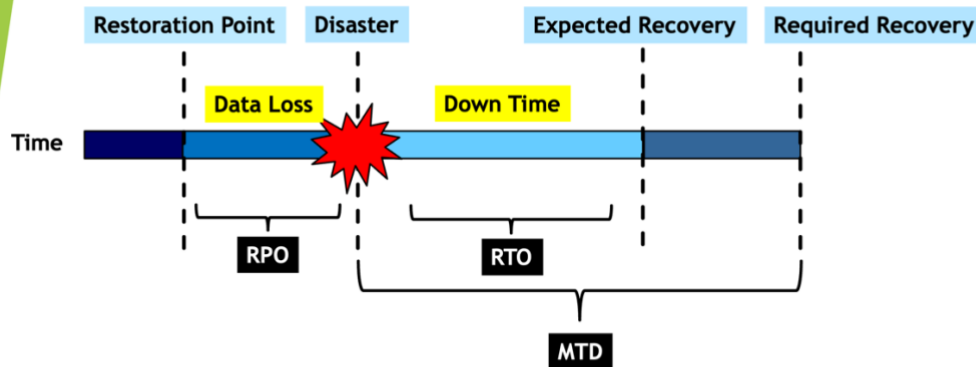
7. **Identifying And Prioritizing Assets**

- 7.1. **First step** of the risk life cycle is **identifying and prioritizing assets**.
- 7.2. Most effective way to prioritize assets is to perform a **BIA**.
- 7.3. Assets can be categorised as – Tangible or intangible.

7.4. The **cost method and market value method** can identify the high-value tangible assets to be protected.

7.5. The **cost method** values an asset based on its **purchase price**, while the **market value** method values an asset based on its **current market price**.

Business Impact Analysis (BIA)



- **Recovery Point Objective** : Acceptable amount of data Company is willing to lose
- **Recovery Time Objective** : Time frame within which an asset must come back online
- **Maximum Tolerable Downtime** : longest downtime an organization can tolerate before facing negative consequences

Chapter – 4

1. All-Hazards Emergency Operations Plan

1.1. The emergency planning format used by the organisation depends on the **nature of the organisation and the organisations policy**.

1.2. The all-hazards approach has been adopted by FEMA and can be used in business and organizational plans as well as community plans.

1.3. All hazards approach provides for a basic emergency operations plan (EOP), with sections that apply to multiple emergency situations such as team and contact lists, plus hazard specific checklists for event types that might be particularly applicable, such as hurricane checklists in coastal areas or flood sections in geographies prone to flooding.

1.4. The all-hazards approach works well in many situations because quite often planning requirements are similar regardless of whether an incident is a natural threat, a human threat, or an accident.

2. Threat-Specific Emergency Operations Plan

2.1. Some organizations might find that their type or kind of business requires very specific plans to be enacted in different emergency situations.

2.2. Each organization must determine the best course of action for their planning needs.

2.3. The plan should be developed in the **simplest way possible**, with outlines of the specific responsibilities for those assigned to emergency response.

3. Considerations for Planning

3.1. **Shelter**. A hold in place or shelter in place is needed, including access to washroom, food and communication.

3.2. **Data search**. It may be useful to bring access control and visitor records to the assembly area so a check of all those recorded as being on-site can be conducted.

3.3. **Assembly areas**. These are places where personnel can stay out of the weather, preferably with access to amenities.

3.4. **Special item removal.** It may be necessary to evacuate information, equipment, laboratory samples, or other items from the site.

3.5. **Alerting of neighbours.** If an evacuation is initiated, neighbours should be notified by either the organization or the responding emergency services.

3.6. **Shutdown procedures.** To be ordered by someone familiar with the process.

3.7. **Security.** In larger sites, areas not related to the location of the device could be locked to provide security during the evacuation.

4. Priorities

4.1. The following is the priority:

- Protect human life.
- Prevent or minimize personal injury.
- Reduce the exposure of assets.
- Optimize loss control for assets whose exposure cannot be reduced.
- Restore normal operations as quickly as possible.

4.2. In setting priorities, certain time-tested principles should be applied to the protection of life. Those principles include the following:

- **Evacuation and shelter.** Move all persons not needed in disaster operations to places of safety.
- **Personal protection.** Ensure that persons who must remain in a threatened area are as well-protected as possible.
- **Rescue and relief.** Provide a ready means of support and assistance for injured

4.3. For preventing or minimizing injury, the following are the guiding principles:

- **Design safety.** Eliminate in advance conditions that increase the likelihood of injury.
- **Training.** Prepare those who will deal with the disaster so they will not increase their exposure through ignorance or ineptitude.

4.4. To reduce exposure of physical assets, a business should conduct good housekeeping and keep valuable materials or equipment from being needlessly concentrated in high-hazard locales.

4.5. To restore normal operations quickly, it may be necessary to relocate some groups or functions and to revise previous schedules and programs.

5. Emergency Operations Centres and Command Posts

5.1. A business should identify a location for use as an emergency operations centre (EOC) or crisis management centre (CMC) from which the emergency response can be directed.

5.2. The size, nature, and location of the organization may dictate the location and scope of its EOC/CMC.

5.3. The organization should also designate one or more alternate locations, including one in a building other than the one that contains the primary EOC/CMC.

5.4. ***"One of the most important ingredients in effectively managing an emergency event is communications."***

6. Command/Management Succession

6.1. The plan must ensure that a senior management representative is always available to take charge.

6.2. A list of emergency telephone numbers for key personnel is also essential. This list should be included in the published emergency plan and updated regularly.

7. Mutual Aid

7.1. In a mutual aid association, businesses and other organizations agree to assist each other by providing materials, equipment, and personnel for disaster control during emergencies.

7.2. The purpose of such an association is to establish a workable emergency management organization that minimizes damage and ensures the continued

operation or early restoration of damaged facilities.

8. Public Affairs/Media Relations

8.1. The emergency plan should provide for the orderly release of information, preferably through a single source in the organization.

8.2. Organizations should be prepared for media requests for interviews with subject matter experts on specialized issues.

8.3. Photographic coverage of the incident scene is important for insurance purposes and to support legal claims.

9. Emergency Medical Services

9.1. Immediate and short-term care of the injured may have to be provided by the medical personnel, if any, who are already present in the organization.

9.2. For organizations with in-house medical support, adequate medical supplies must be provided to treat the injured properly.

9.3. Emergency planners should contact local hospitals to determine the number of emergency patients each can accommodate and the types of treatment available.

9.4. For a mass casualty situation, space must be designated for triage, where trained medical personnel evaluate the injured and prioritize them for treatment.

10. Emergency Shutdown and Restoration

10.1. The emergency plan should assign specific responsibility for equipment shutdown.

10.2. The actual shutdown should be assigned to people familiar with the process.

10.3. Shutdown crews may be the last to leave the facility when evacuation is ordered, and they may even have to stay in the facility. Hence, maximum protection should be planned for shutdown crews, including a shelter that gives good assurance of survival.

Chapter – 5 : Crisis Management Planning

1. Parts of A Crisis Plan

1.1. The crisis plan will need to be tailored to the specific needs of the business and its mission. However, some typical aspects of crisis management plans include:

- Crisis management team;
- Crisis management activation and escalation;
- Crisis command and management succession;
- Crisis recovery logistics and resources; and
- Crisis communications.

2. Crisis Communication

2.1. ***Like crisis management, crisis communications is strategic, not tactical.***

2.2. The crisis communications plan (CCP) can either be a standalone document or be integrated into the overall crisis management plan.

2.3. The CCP will list the members of the CCT and their roles.

2.4. The most important part of the CCP is the actual communications section.

2.5. The CCT will document the following for each disruptive scenario:

- Identify affected or key audiences.
- Identify audience concerns.
- Develop messages specific to audience concerns.
- Determine a spokesperson/messenger for each audience.
- Select tactics to deliver each message.

2.6. Communications tactics are those tools used to carry messages to specific audiences such as news releases, social media, use of a company's website, town halls, etc. ***They should not be confused with strategic communications.***

2.7. ***Spinning*** means a communicator goes on a news program and attempts to downplay the significance of the crisis, deflect blame and get attention away from the core issues.

2.8. Essential to have a crisis communication plan prepared in advance so that less time is spent determining what to say, how to say it, and by whom.

2.9. Programs and teams

2.9.1. An effective crisis communications program is comprised of the same elements of a crisis management program: ***planning, training, exercising, response, and recovery.***

2.9.2. The size of a crisis communications team will be dictated by the organization in terms of size, management levels, regions, or facilities. In most medium to large organizations, the roles are as follows:

Senior Communications Advisor/Lead. The senior communications advisor is typically the most senior communications person in the organization and is ultimately responsible for crisis communications.

Crisis Communications Team Lead. Leads the crisis communications team, executes the crisis communications plan, and ensures deadlines are met.

Crisis Communications Team (CCT). The CCT represents various communications functions within the organization.

Chapter – 6 : Event Specific Plan

1. General Response to a Crisis.

1.1. Pre-incident considerations:

- 1.1.1. Determine threat management team members.
- 1.1.2. Establish roles, responsibilities, procedures, and training for key response personnel.
- 1.1.3. Conduct awareness, education, and training programs for employees.
- 1.1.4. Provide emergency response equipment and materials.
- 1.1.5. Liaise with external public safety organizations.
- 1.1.6. Select an ***Emergency operations center (EOC) and incident command center (ICC)*** for direction, coordination, and communication with both the internal and external responders.
- 1.1.7. Establish a media staging area and a family notification/reunification area that is safe and distant from any ongoing operations.

1.2. Post-incident considerations:

- 1.2.1. ***Immediate phase*** - life safety, accounting for all individuals onsite, communications with employees, families, public, and the media.
- 1.2.2. ***Short-term phase*** - preserve crime scene, monitor individuals for signs of psychological trauma, assist individuals in reunification and other incident-related efforts, continue to communicate information.
- 1.2.3. ***Long-term phase*** - conduct post-incident debrief with internal and external responders and stakeholders, replenish supplies, and continue communications with appropriate groups.

2. Pandemic.

2.1. WHO's Six Phases of Pandemic.

- 2.1.1. Phase 1: No new influenza virus subtypes have been detected in humans.
- 2.1.2. Phase 2: No new influenza virus subtypes have been detected in humans. However, a circulating ***animal*** influenza virus subtypes poses a substantial risk.
- 2.1.3. Phase 3: Human infection with a new subtype, but no human to human spread.
- 2.1.4. Phase 4: Small clusters with limited human-to-human transmission, but spread is highly localized, suggesting that the virus is not well-adapted to humans.

2.1.5. Phase 5: Large clusters, but human-to-human spread still localized, suggesting that the virus is becoming increasingly better adapted to humans, but may not yet be fully transmissible (substantial pandemic risk).

2.1.6. Phase 6: Pandemic: increased and sustained transmission in general

2.2. Planning response to Pandemic

Phase	Business Continuity	Communications	Technology	Facilities	Human Resources
1 & 2	Identify essential services. Prepare to switch to Work from Home (WFH). Adequate staff backup	Create a Pandemic manager & response team. Develop information sharing processes. Develop internal & external matrix for the six levels of alert.	Prepare VPN. Plan for support access for WFH. Develop information sharing plan.	Review building access procedures. Adequate medical supplies available.	Review employee policies & Procedures. SOP for self reporting of illness.
Phase 3	Confirm & review key supplier plans. Communicate BCM plans to stake holders.	Create general awareness of pandemic & preventive measures.			Update policies on-Overseas travel. Medical leave Recalling employees.
Phase 4 & 5	Evacuate if business & dependent systems are operational or if workaround should be enacted. Conduct business using virtual protocols.	Update employees & all stakeholders regularly of the action taken.	Verify technical support can handle increased traffic.	Activate agreements with cleaning / decontamination contractors. Inform external parties of restrictions on visits to business premises.	Implement all policies. Make arrangements for counselling support.
Phase 6		Assess pre scripted messages & adjust for changing conditions. Address rumours & misinformation.	Track network & electronic data processing system demands. Verify access to increased bandwidth.	Clean surfaces. Adhere to health guidelines by the government.	Monitor employee health & needs. Develop policies for assisting employees.

Important Quick Reads

Bombs Threats

Entry of personnel and materials: most important countermeasure to bombs

Notification order: search and evacuation personnel, local police, explosive demolition teams, and medical facilities

Search: after every bomb threat

Search conducted by: employees familiar with the work area

Covert search: selected personnel; **Overt** search: everyone

Search includes: common areas, occupied areas and unoccupied areas

Elevators: ground floor

No: radios or cell phones

Full evacuation: when caller is credible, and location unknown

Do not wait for police to order the evacuation of the building

Do not use main entrance for evacuation unless necessary.

Removal of a suspected bomb: or use of bomb blanket by disposal personnel only

Bomb threat emergency plan: employee training, contact local police, and military EODD

Fire

Mutual assistance and **prior coordination** with the fire department is essential

Single greatest destroyer of property

Halon fire extinguishing equipment: replaced by water

Automatic sprinklers: activated by melting metal seals; hence, water

Smoke detectors: most common safety device

Ionization fire detector: detects invisible products of combustion (germinal/ incipient sensor)

Thermal fire detectors: respond to a predetermined temperature, or increase

Photoelectric smoke detectors: respond to light source changes/interruptions

Obscuration detectors: measure decreases in light due to smoke

Partial high-rise evacuation: includes the floor above and below the fire

Kidnapping

Executive protection: difficult to convince the executive of need

Ransom payment decision: made by the highest corporate level

Escape: only if chances for success are good.

Strikes & Labour Disputes

Strike: concerted refusal to work in an attempt to have demands met

Economic strike: most the frequent

Unfair labour practice strike: sudden and strikers must be allowed to return

Lockout: refusal to allow bargaining unit members on the premises

Mobilize supervisory personnel in patrol groups if no guard force is available

Armed guards: not advisable in labor disputes

Vital Records

Identification of vital records must be included in emergency planning

Types of vital records: incorporation certificate, by-laws, and stock record books

Disaster

Disaster control: planning/prevention, mutual assistance, and community resources

Hot site: an off-site location designed for up and running after a disaster

Machine shutdown: assigned to the persons familiar with the process

Earthquake emergency plans: to include pre-selected cover (e.g., center of building)

Ground movement: not usually the direct cause of injury or death

Plan Organization

Planning: proposals, analysis, **alternate plans**, and methods for achieving future goals

Planning responsibility: shared between government and industry

Plan: anticipate emergency, provide action plan, and **restore** normal operations

Plan: directive in writing, and include a glossary, appendices, and list of resources

Plan keys: realistic test, maintain records to correct deficiencies, and coordinated testing exercises with locals

Plan distribution: all personnel with responsibility for action

Plan activation: plant manager, president, or CEO (not security)

Life safety codes: dictates safety measures for business

Hazard: any condition, behavior, or object that can cause accident, injury, or death

Surprise plan tests: to be conducted

Plant manager: not to attempt personal charge of all plant operations

Priorities: prevent, protect life, reduce exposure, **restore**, and minimize loss

Business leadership continuity: essential to emergency planning (especially in a crisis)

Emergency coordinator: appointed at the corporate level with succession

Media relations coordinator: to be appointed

Key plan personnel: EAP, rescue teams, and radiation safety

Existing (as opposed to new) organizations: to be trained to take care of the situation

Types of emergencies addressed: not be limited to the past

Mutual aid association (MAA): voluntary agreement within an industry to assist one another

MAA expenses: defray among the association

Capital outlay and operating costs: usually high

MAA operating element: operating board of directors

Quantifiable Facts

Bomb threats: 2 to 5 % of bomb threats are real (most popular act among terrorist)

Evacuee holding area: at least 300 feet away

Emergency water: 1 gallon/day/person

Vehicle stand off distance: 80 feet

Plan revision: as needed, and tested at least once a year

Vital records (2%): critical to the survival of the business; decide rapidly

NLRA (Wagner Act): requires 60 days notice by union (replacements allowed)

Earthquake duration: a few seconds or up to 5 minutes

Hurricane watch: expected to develop within 36 hours

Hurricane warning: expected to develop within 24 hours

Heavy snow warning: 4" in 12 hours or 6" in 24 hours

Blizzard warning: winds 35+ MPH

Process | Performance | Protection